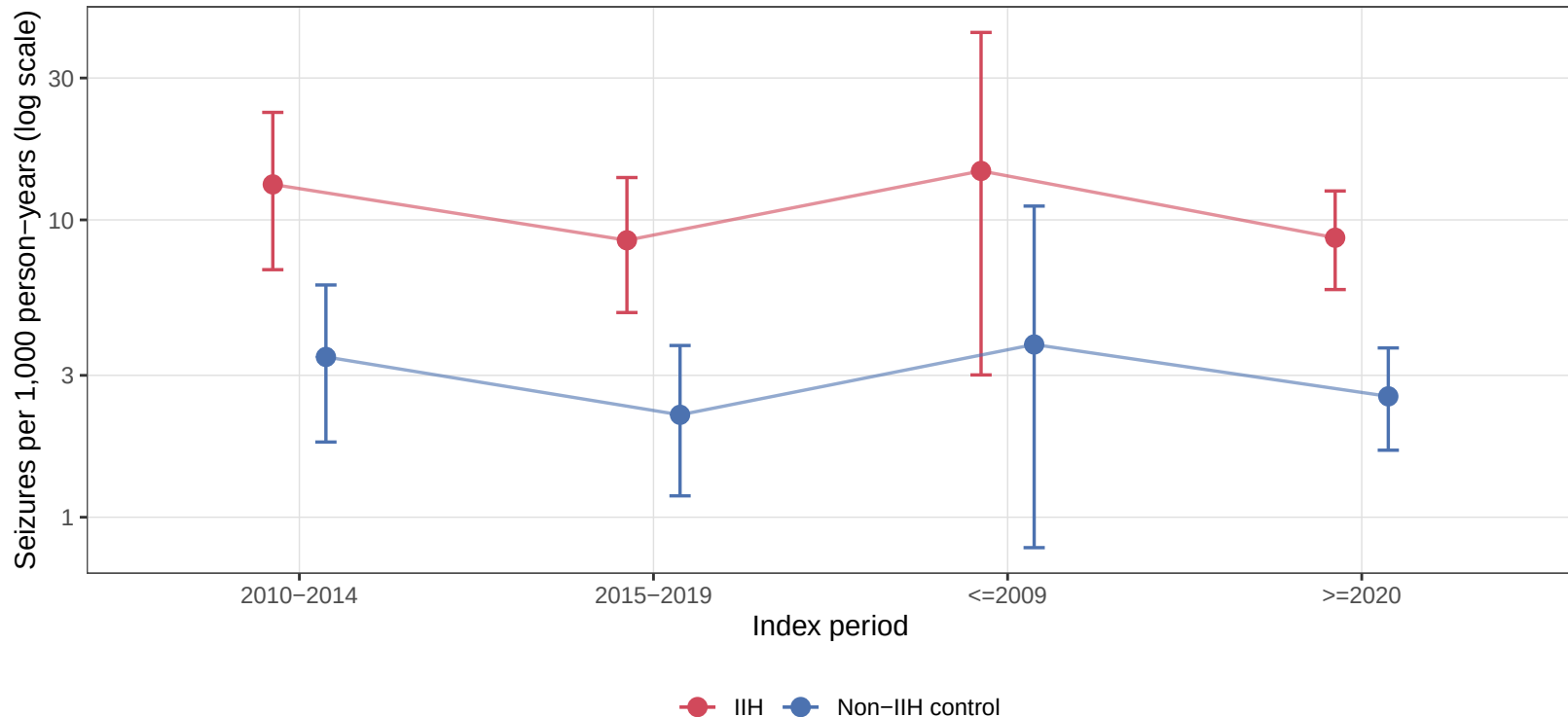


The association is stable across calendar eras

Exposure x era interaction $p = 0.994$. The ICD-9 to ICD-10 transition (Oct 2015) falls between the middle two bands.



Absolute rates fall over time in BOTH arms, so the decline is a feature of the cohorts or of ascertainment, not of the contrast: the ratio is unchanged. That is the reassuring pattern — a coding artefact would have moved one arm relative to the other. Early bands rest on very few events and their intervals are wide.